

John Radford

DevOps Engineer & Systems Programmer

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📍 Pittsburgh, PA

🌐 <https://johnlradford.io>

🔗 <https://github.com/BlueSquare23>

🌐 <https://www.linkedin.com/in/johnlradford>

SUMMARY

DevOps engineer and systems programmer with 9+ years at a production web hosting company.

Applies computer science fundamentals and insightful technical leadership to build internal tooling, automation, and secure infrastructure end-to-end, from distributed KVM clusters to custom RAG pipelines, with an emphasis on coding clean user experience for internal teams. Writes production Perl, Python, and Go. Mentors junior staff, owns Linux systems, and ships full-stack tools and applications.

SKILLS

Languages: Perl, Python, GoLang, Bash, PHP, JS/TS

IaC Tools: Gitlab, Github Actions, Jenkins, Puppet, Ansible, Terraform

Web Frameworks: Perl PSGI, Perl Mojo, Python Flask, NodeJS, Go net/http

EXPERIENCE

Pair Networks, Inc.

Pittsburgh PA

DevOps Engineer & Systems Administrator

Jan 2023 – May 2026

Designed and built internal applications and tooling for a production web hosting operation, primarily in Python and Perl.

Built CI/CD pipelines using IaC/CaC/MaC with Puppet and Ansible and monitoring via Icinga2 and ELK, deployed using GitOps.

Flagship projects include: a Virtual Resource Manager (per-host REST agents, weighted rebalancing algo, and a REPL CLI) for thousands of QEMU/KVM guests across dozens of physical hosts on multiple network segments, a ChromaDB-backed RAG pipeline powering internal support LLMs, and a Redis-cached IP threat intelligence service. Also shipped Zendesk webhook APIs, Nginx/Apache rate limiting, a CloudLinux rollout across entire shared hosting fleet, and KPI and web statistics pipelines that eliminated recurring manual reporting.

Pair Networks, Inc.

Pittsburgh PA

NOC & SOC Engineer

Jan 2020 – Dec 2022

Held concurrent Security and NOC roles, monitoring, detecting, and remediating intrusions and triaging live hardware and software incidents on production servers. Also covered Level 2 support, abuse handling, and account migrations, and helped maintain the ELK logging stack and SOC/SIEM infrastructure.

Pair Networks, Inc.

Pittsburgh PA

Support Technician - Lvl 2

Aug 2018 – Dec 2019

Resolved customer issues across web hosting, email, DNS, domains, databases, and PHP while building deep Linux expertise across the full hosting stack. Automated SSL renewal notifications, replacing a manual process and saving an estimated 200+ hours (roughly \$10-15K) per year.

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh - Greensburg

B.A. • 3.8

Major: Humanities Gen (Philosophy, Art History, Classical Literature); Minor: Political Science
Greensburg PA • Aug 2014 – Dec 2017

PROJECTS

Web-LGSM

A web portal for managing Linux game servers.

<https://github.com/BlueSquare23/web-lgsm>

Term::ReadLine::Repl

A batteries included interactive Term::ReadLine REPL module published to CPAN.

<https://metacpan.org/pod/Term::ReadLine::Repl>